solve the drug problem without a judicial system that works and without adequate police force.

Mr. Tancredo. Thank you.

Chairman Berman. The time of the gentleman has expired.

Gentlemen, you have been very patient with us. We have two more people. Can you squeeze in another two 5-minute periods? If so, that is wonderful. The gentlelady from California, Ms. Woolsey.

Mr. Woolsey. Thank you very much. So, all right, we are talking about narcotics and we are talking about how much it affects everything that is going on in that part of the world, what is going to happen with our young people, their young people, the average age, what, of a Pakistani is 21 years old. They need a future. What, you have been over there, what do you think the alternative crop is? What are the crops besides poppies? What is the market? How do we get these young people engaged in being educated and doing the right things and wanting to do the right things?

I mean we are a nation that really does not know enough about alternative areas in the world. We tell them how we think they should do it and then we are so surprised they will not do it because we are talking as Americans. So I guess could I get you started on that and then I would appreciate it?

General Jones. Thank you. One of the things that I think we have to understand is that during the Russian occupation of Afghanistan as a means of controlling the population the Russians destroyed the irrigation system of Afghanistan, which was really fairly sophisticated and complex and supported agricultural diversity in the country. Clearly what has to be done is in order to give the agricultural reform a chance to succeed is to rebuild the irrigation system and provide a comprehensive plan to wean the economy off of its narcotic leaning and dependency.

This is not going to be done overnight. It was not, this problem was not created overnight. But you can see it grow exponentially every single year. One thing about the narcotic crop in Afghanistan is you can visually see it as opposed to some of the areas the Ambassador worked in where it was in jungles and hidden. In Afghanistan you can measure it because all you have to do is go up on a clear day and when the poppies are in bloom you can see exactly how the problem is growing.

But there are alternatives. And it takes, it is going to take the reforms that I think we suggested in our reports and it is going to take the focus of agricultural experts internationally to massively turn the attention to the problem of water, to the problem of irrigation, and to the problem of supporting a livelihood. But in a secure way the problem of the lack of security is that even if they had the wherewithal to plant the crops and grow them, without adequate security at night when the army is not there and the police is not corrupt and is inadequately trained the population gets caught between the struggle, and what they have been doing for the last few years is waiting to see which side is going to win.

Mr. Woolsey. Well maybe, Ambassador Pickring, you could follow up on that with we have been there for 7 years, I mean we were involved before that in Afghanistan, have we started? Are there any plans to help them with the irrigation system? If it were built would it remain or would it be destroyed or why are we not doing it?

Ambassador Pickring. We helped them in the monarchy build the irrigation system in Helmand and Kandahar in particular, so we know it. Some have told me that in fact the

Copyright © 2010. Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated. All rights reserved.

Combating Islamic Militancy and Terrorism in Pakistan's Border Region, Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated, 2010. ProQuest Ebook Central,